

Troubleshooting Flow: Monitor Shows Blank Screen but CPU Appears to Be Running

Step 1: Confirm the monitor is powered on

- Check that the monitor's power LED is lit.
 - Verify the power cable is securely connected to both the monitor and the wall outlet.
 - Try a different power outlet if there is no power indication.
 - **If the monitor has no power:** Resolve the power issue or replace the power cable/monitor.
 - **If the monitor is powered on:** Continue troubleshooting.
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Step 2: Check the monitor input/source selection

- Press the monitor's input/source button and confirm the correct input is selected (HDMI, DisplayPort, VGA, etc.).
 - Ensure the selected input matches the cable connection from the computer.
 - **If the wrong input is selected:** Switch to the correct source and check if the display returns.
 - **If the input is correct:** Continue.
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Step 3: Inspect and reseal display cables

- Check that the video cable is securely connected to both the monitor and the computer.
- Disconnect and reconnect the cable firmly.
- Look for damaged cables or bent connectors.
- If possible, test with another known-working cable.

- **If the display works after replacing/reconnecting the cable:** The issue was a loose or faulty connection.
 - **If the screen is still blank:** Continue.
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Step 4: Verify the correct display output port

- Check whether the cable is connected to the correct port:
 - If the computer has a dedicated graphics card, connect the monitor to the graphics card output.
 - Avoid connecting to the motherboard video port if a separate graphics card is installed.
 - **If connected to the wrong port:** Move the cable to the correct port and test again.
 - **If the port is correct:** Continue.
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Step 5: Check for display activity

- Press the monitor's menu button to confirm the monitor itself can display its settings.
 - Try connecting the monitor to another computer or connecting another monitor to the same computer.
 - **If another monitor works:** The original monitor may be faulty.
 - **If another monitor also shows no display:** Continue.
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Step 6: Perform basic computer restart checks

- Restart the computer completely.
- Disconnect unnecessary USB devices and peripherals.

- Observe whether the computer shows startup screens, error messages, or BIOS information.
 - **If the display works after restarting:** The issue may have been a temporary system or hardware state.
 - **If the screen remains blank:** Continue.
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Step 7: Check display settings (if the system starts but no image appears)

- Try keyboard shortcuts:
 - Press **Windows + P** to open display mode options.
 - Select **Duplicate** or **Extend** to restore output.
 - If possible, boot into Safe Mode and check:
 - Display resolution settings.
 - Graphics driver status.
 - Update or reinstall the graphics driver if needed.
 - **If incorrect settings were causing the issue:** Adjust settings and restart.
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Step 8: Check internal hardware

- If there is still no display:
 - Reseat the RAM modules.
 - Check that the graphics card is properly seated (if applicable).
 - Listen for beep codes or check diagnostic LEDs.
- **If hardware faults are identified:** Repair or replace the faulty component.